



StoreFactory

Describe your business. Get a real one.

One sentence in, a working business out — **website, bookings, shop, content, domain and email marketing**, built, hosted and operated for you. Change any of it later by asking.

● **Live**

OPEN BETA

80+

REGISTERED USERS

4

MERCHANT SITES LIVE

£150k

ANGEL ROUND

— THE PROBLEM

Getting a small business online is still **a stack of subscriptions** — or an agency invoice.

A REAL BUSINESS NEEDS

📄 A website

📅 Bookings

🛒 A shop

📄 Content

🌐 A domain

✉ Email marketing

OPTION A · DO IT YOURSELF

Five tools, five logins

£120 – £250 / month

- ◆ Site builder, booking app, shop platform, mail tool and registrar, each billed separately
- ◆ Nothing shares a customer record — the same person is five different rows
- ◆ Shopify and Wix take a cut of every sale, and the app store adds more
- ◆ Every integration is the owner's problem, forever

Cheap to start. Expensive and brittle by month six.

OPTION B · HIRE IT OUT

An agency build

£5,000 – £50,000 upfront

- ◆ Six to twelve weeks before anything is live
- ◆ Out of reach for the corner shop, the clinic and the maker
- ◆ Every change afterwards is a quote, a ticket and a wait
- ◆ The business does not own the ability to change its own site

Exactly what they want. At a price almost none of them can pay.

OPTION C · AI SITE BUILDERS

A beautiful page

Minutes to a demo

- ◆ Generates a landing page, then hands back a codebase
- ◆ No bookings, no orders, no customers, no email list
- ◆ Deploying, domains and payments are still yours to solve
- ◆ Nothing to open on Monday morning to run the business

A website, not a business. The demo is the whole product.



The gap is not **generating a website**. It is everything that has to exist behind one — and staying able to change it without hiring anybody.

Three things became true at once — none of them were true in 2022.

01

Models stopped scaffolding and started maintaining

Agentic coding — tool use, file edits, running code in a sandbox and reading the result — means a model can change a live application on the twentieth request as reliably as it built it on the first. A one-shot generator produces a demo. This produces a product a merchant can keep.

THEN	Generate a template, hand over the repo
NOW	Own the merchant's codebase, indefinitely

02

Every layer of commerce became an API

Headless commerce, headless CMS, payments, transactional email, DNS and hosting are all API-first now. A complete business stack can be provisioned by a program instead of assembled by a person — which is exactly the part agencies were charging five figures for.

THEN	A developer wires the stack by hand
NOW	One API call per merchant, start to finish

03

Compute got cheap enough to give everyone their own

Containerised backends on commodity hardware put a real, isolated stack per merchant — their own database, their own admin, their own deployments — inside a £25/month price point. Isolation used to be an enterprise line item. It is now a rounding error.

THEN	Shared templates, or enterprise pricing
NOW	A dedicated stack each, at SMB prices



Any one of these alone is a feature. Together they make the agency build **automatable** — and StoreFactory is built on all three.

A sentence about your business, and the whole thing gets built.

1 Describe your business

A sentence or two is enough. Attach a logo or a product list if you have one.

2 Answer a couple of questions

The builder asks only for what is missing, then shows you its plan before it builds anything.

3 Your site goes live

Pages, bookings, content and domain, wired up and deployed — not a download, a running business.

Then keep asking

Every change afterwards is another sentence. No agency, no ticket, no redeploy to think about.

⚡ The output is not a template or a repository. It is a **running business** — on its own domain, taking bookings and orders, that the owner can change by asking.

storefactory.shop · new business

THE BRIEF

"I run a barbershop in Leeds and want customers to book their own appointments online."

WHAT GETS BUILT

- ✓ **Site** — home, services, about, contact
- ✓ **Bookings** — services, availability, self-serve reschedule
- ✓ **Content** — pages and posts, editable without a deploy
- ✓ **Marketing** — subscriber list on a verified sending domain
- ✓ **Infrastructure** — hosting, HTTPS, domain, backups
- ✓ **Shop** — switched on the day they start selling

Every plan carries a monthly credit allowance, and **most changes cost one credit** — iterating is a chat message, not a change request.

leedsbarbers.co.uk

● Live

Everything a small business runs on, **in one place.**

Every capability below is shipped and reachable in a merchant's dashboard today, except where marked. Every paid plan has all of them — plans differ by how much you use, not by what you unlock.



LIVE

Build and change it by asking

Describe what you want in plain English and watch it get built. Every plan carries a monthly credit allowance for it.



LIVE

Live on your own domain

Buy a domain here or point one you own. DNS, certificates and renewals are handled for you.



LIVE

Bookings and appointments

Publish availability and take bookings. Slots are held atomically — the same time can never be sold twice.



LIVE

Content manager

Edit copy, publish posts and swap images without touching code or waiting on a deploy.



LIVE

Email marketing

Lists, imports and campaigns sent from the merchant's own verified domain — mail arrives as them, not as us.



LIVE

Cart, checkout and orders

Products, cart, checkout and orders. Included on every paid plan, switched on the day they start selling.



LIVE

Hosting, deploys and security

Global hosting, HTTPS, backups and updates are ours. No server to patch, no build to babysit.



IN BUILD

Automations

Follow-ups, reminders and routine jobs triggered by what happens in the business. Reachable, not finished.



No transaction fees, ever. Merchants connect their own Stripe account and keep 100% of every sale — the single thing they ask about first, and the thing Shopify and Wix cannot match.

The hard part isn't the copy. **It's what gets provisioned.**

STEP 01 Brief A sentence, plus anything attached	STEP 02 Plan Agent asks for what's missing, then proposes	STEP 03 Build Code written and run in an isolated sandbox	STEP 04 Preview Owner sees it before anything ships	STEP 05 Provision Repo, CMS, backend, database, domain, mail	STEP 06 Live Deployed, HTTPS, on their own domain
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CREATED FOR EVERY MERCHANT, AUTOMATICALLY

-  **Their own storefront codebase**
In its own repository, deployed to a global edge network
-  **Their own database**
A dedicated Postgres instance, not a shared tenant row
-  **Their own commerce backend**
A containerised Medusa stack with an admin they log into
-  **Their own CMS tenant**
Pages, posts and media, edited without a deploy
-  **Their domain and certificates**
Registrar purchase or transfer, DNS records, TLS, renewals
-  **Their verified sending domain**
Campaigns leave as the merchant, with their own reputation

All of it stood up **without a human in the loop** — the same checklist an agency works through over six weeks, executed as code in minutes.

WHY THIS IS HARD TO COPY

- 1 The pipeline is the product**
Anyone can prompt a model into a landing page. Turning that into a provisioned, isolated, billable stack — and keeping it running — is a year of edge cases, not a weekend.
- 2 The AI margin is engineered**
Model spend is metered per run with prompt caching, and priced into a credit allowance. Gross margin on AI usage is a design decision here, not something we find out at the end of the month.
- 3 We own the runtime, so we keep the relationship**
Because the business runs on our infrastructure, we can keep changing it forever. Competitors who hand back a repo hand back the customer with it.

STOREFRONT & PLATFORM

Next.js React Vercel edge Tailwind

COMMERCE & CONTENT

Medusa v2 Payload CMS Postgres
Redis

INFRASTRUCTURE

Dedicated hosts Docker + Traefik
Supabase E2B sandboxes

AI & SERVICES

Claude OpenAI Vertex Stripe
Resend PostHog

Not a prototype — real businesses are running on it.

80+

REGISTERED USERS

Signed up since open beta launched, growing weekly with no paid acquisition.

4

LIVE MERCHANT SITES

Real businesses trading on their own domains, built end to end by the platform.

250+

AI EDITS SHIPPED

Merchants iterating on their own sites by asking — the retention loop, working.

£0

SPENT ON ACQUISITION

Every user to date arrived through founder network, content and word of mouth.

LIVE TODAY, BUILT FROM A SENTENCE

Bonsai Essentials

"A calm shop for my bonsai trees, tools and starter kits."

Batch Chocolate

"A site for my chocolate company: small batches, story first, shop second."

Sindicate HQ

"A bold home for my music production company: our work, our artists."

Skeen Deep

"A site for my esthetics clinic: treatments, bookings and skincare advice."

HOW WE GOT HERE

Q4 2025

Core platform built

Agent, sandbox, provisioning and deploy pipeline.

Q1 2026

Open beta, first live sites

First merchants trading on their own domains.

Q2-Q3 2026

The business layer shipped

Bookings, marketing, CMS, domains, commerce admin, usage plans.

NOW

Raising to commercialise

£150k to convert a working product into paying customers.

⚡ The build risk is behind us. Plans, billing, limits and self-serve signup are **shipped and switched on** — what is left is demand, and that is what this round buys.

A large, recurring market. We need a sliver of it.

Every figure below is built bottom-up from merchant counts and the prices we actually charge, not top-down from an analyst headline.

■ TAM · TOTAL ADDRESSABLE

\$61.8B

Global SMB commerce & web-presence software

What small businesses worldwide already spend every year to be online and sell — the budget we are competing for, not creating.

BOTTOM-UP

~**100M** online SMEs globally
× ~**\$600** / year average platform spend
= ~**\$60B** annually

Category growing at roughly 20% a year as offline businesses keep moving online.

■ SAM · SERVICEABLE

£2.5B

UK & English-speaking SME merchants

Where we can sell today: one language, one support model, one payments and domains story, no localisation work required.

BOTTOM-UP

~**5M** UK / IE / AU SME merchants
× **£500** / year blended ARPA
= **£2.5B** annually

£500 sits between our Starter plan (£300/yr) and Growth (£1,188/yr and up).

■ SOM · OBTAINABLE

£5M

Target ARR by year three

What this round is aimed at: a real business at a fraction of a percent of the market we can already reach.

BOTTOM-UP

10,000 merchants acquired
× **£500** / year blended ARPA
= **£5M** ARR

Under 0.2% of SAM. The plan does not require us to beat Shopify — only to be the obvious choice for a slice of it.



This is a **replacement cycle, not a new category**. The money is already being spent, every month, on a stack of tools nobody enjoys owning.

Everyone solves one column. Nobody solves the row.

APPROACH	LIVE IN MINUTES	NO DEV TEAM	BOOKINGS, SHOP & EMAIL IN ONE	DOMAIN & INFRA HANDLED	NO CUT OF YOUR SALES	CHANGE IT LATER BY ASKING
Website builders Shopify · Wix · Squarespace	✓	✓	—	✓	✗	✗
Agency or freelancer Custom build, £5k–£50k	✗	✗	✓	—	✓	✗
AI site builders Prompt-to-page tools	✓	—	✗	✗	✓	—
StoreFactory From £25 / month	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

⚡ The builders own convenience, the agencies own capability, the AI tools own speed. **Nobody has put all three in one product a corner shop can afford** — and the last column is the one that keeps customers.

Recurring revenue that **grows with the merchant.**

FREE

£0

50 credits / month

A real, live site on a storefactory.shop address. Free forever — the top of the funnel, not a trial that expires.

STARTER

£25 /mo

200 credits / month

Their own domain, plus bookings, shop, content and email marketing switched on. 30-day free trial.

GROWTH

£99–£499 /mo

500 – 5,000 credits / month

A five-step slider: bigger allowances, bigger database, up to 5 stores, priority support.

ENTERPRISE

Bespoke

Negotiated

Multi-site groups, franchises and agencies, handled directly. Annual billing charges 10 months — two free.

FOUR REVENUE LINES, ONE RELATIONSHIP



Subscriptions **Primary · recurring**

£25 to £499 a month, monthly or annual. Predictable MRR that upgrades as the merchant does.



AI credit top-ups **Usage · high margin**

100 for £10, 500 for £40, 1,500 for £100. Merchants who use the product most pay the most, automatically.



Domain sales **Attach · recurring**

Sold and renewed in-product. A small margin on a purchase merchants make anyway, and a strong lock-in.



Done-for-you builds **Services · cash now**

Delivered through Piranha Studios in about a week. Funds operations today and seeds subscriptions tomorrow.

LIMITS, NOT LOCKS

Every plan has **every feature** — bookings, shop, content, marketing, custom domain. Tiers differ only by how much a merchant does each month. Nobody is told a feature is not for them; they are told they have outgrown their allowance.

ORDERS / MONTH

Starter 100 → Growth 1,000

BOOKINGS / MONTH

Starter 300 → Growth 1,500

EMAIL SENDS / MONTH

Starter 2,000 → Growth 10,000

TEAM SEATS

Starter 3 → Growth 10

Why it matters commercially: upgrades are triggered by the merchant succeeding, not by us withholding something — expansion revenue is designed in, not negotiated.

Software margins, with the AI cost engineered in.

£150

TARGET CAC

Community and content led, with a free tier doing the qualifying.

£2,500

TARGET LTV · 5 YEAR

Subscription plus credits, domains and plan upgrades over the life of the account.

16:1

LTV TO CAC

Well above the 3:1 a SaaS business is usually asked to clear.

~4 mo

CAC PAYBACK

Each cohort funds the next one inside a single quarter.

WHERE A STARTER SUBSCRIPTION GOES

Subscription		£25.00
Hosting & database		−£2.80
AI inference, metered		−£2.00
Email, DNS & services		−£0.70
Gross margin		~78%

Illustrative at Starter, our thinnest tier — **margin widens with every step up**, because infrastructure per merchant barely moves while price does. Credit top-ups carry a higher margin still.

WHY THESE NUMBERS HOLD



AI cost is capped by design

Usage is sold as a credit allowance and metered per run with prompt caching. Nobody can consume unbounded inference on a fixed fee.



Infrastructure is commodity, not cloud-premium

Backends run as containers on dedicated hosts, not per-service managed plans — which is what makes a £25 tier profitable at all.



The free-to-paid trigger is concrete

Free gets a real live site; their *own domain* is what costs £25. They upgrade the moment they decide the business is real.



Churn is structurally low

Domain, catalogue, bookings, content and mailing list all live here. Leaving is not a cancellation, it is a migration.

CAC, LTV and payback are **targets** underpinning the plan, not measured results — the platform has been in free open beta and has spent nothing on acquisition to date. Validating them against real cohorts is the first milestone this round funds.

Free to start. Paid at the moment of commitment.

ACQUISITION Be where they already ask Reddit & LinkedIn Answering "how do I get my business online" as a practitioner, not an advertiser SEO Long-tail intent: barber booking site, clinic website, small shop online Founder network Piranha Studios' existing SME relationships £150 Target blended CAC	ACTIVATION A live site before they leave Type one sentence The homepage is the product — the brief box is the first screen Social sign-in No card, no setup call, no sales gate Free forever A real site on a storefactory.shop address, not a countdown Minutes Signup to a live site	RETENTION Give them a reason to return It runs the business Bookings, orders and campaigns bring them back weekly Changes are free-form Every improvement is a sentence, not a ticket In-app support Direct help for paid accounts, community for free 250+ AI edits by beta users	REVENUE Charge at the commitment Their own domain The upgrade trigger: a real business wants a real address Allowances, not locks Growth is bought when the merchant grows Credits & domains Top-ups and renewals on top of subscription £25 → £499 Expansion path per account	REFERRAL Let the sites sell it Powered by StoreFactory A credit on every free site, seen by their customers Showcase Consented merchant stories on the marketing site Word of mouth SME owners talk to other SME owners constantly £0 Acquisition spend to date
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THE COMPOUNDING LOOP

A merchant **ships a site** → their customers **see it work** → some **sign up free** → a share **buy a domain** → that funds **the next cohort** ↺

Break-even in year two, **profitable in year three.**

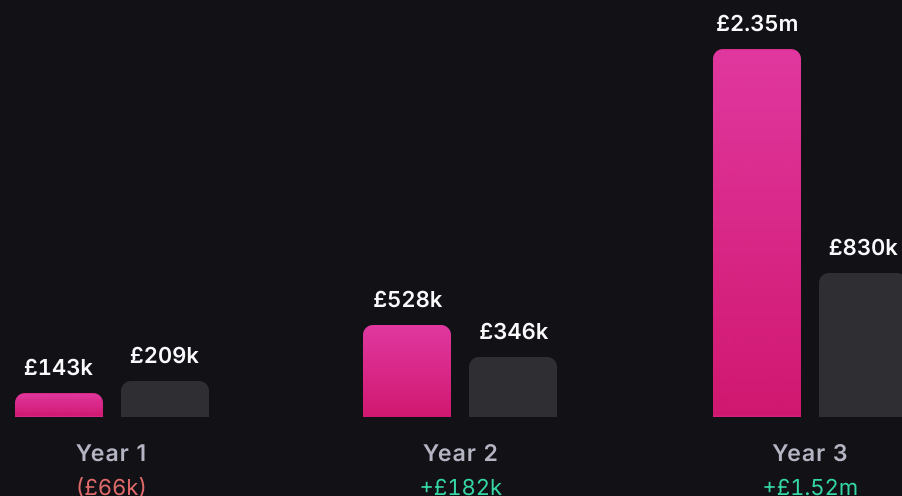
THREE-YEAR PLAN

METRIC	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3
Active customers	150	400	1,200
Blended ARPA / year	£952	£1,320	£1,960
Revenue	£142,800	£528,000	£2,352,000
Operating costs	£208,560	£345,600	£830,400
Net profit / (loss)	(£65,760)	£182,400	£1,521,600

What drives ARPA upward: the mix shifts from Starter to Growth as merchants outgrow their allowances, and credit top-ups, domains and done-for-you builds land on top of the subscription.

REVENUE VS OPERATING COST

■ Revenue ■ Operating cost



~78%

GROSS MARGIN

~350

CUSTOMERS TO BREAK
EVEN

12 mo

TO CASH-FLOW
POSITIVE



The plan turns on one number: **getting to roughly 350 paying merchants.** Everything after that is the same motion, repeated.

— THE ASK

£150,000 to turn a finished product into a paying customer base.

RAISING

£150,000

Angel round · Piranha Studios Ltd

Product & engineering £60,000 · 40%

Marketing & acquisition £45,000 · 30%

Infrastructure & operations £30,000 · 20%

Legal & contingency £15,000 · 10%

This is not a build round. The platform is live and billable — the money buys demand, the first two hires and the runway to prove the acquisition maths on real cohorts.

WHAT THE MONEY BUYS, IN ORDER

MONTH 1-3

Commercial launch

Come out of free beta, switch on paid plans for the existing base, and open the acquisition channels: content, Reddit and LinkedIn, SEO for booking and shop intent.

First paying cohort · CAC measured, not assumed

MONTH 4-6

150 paying merchants

Hire a growth marketer and a customer success lead. Validate CAC, payback and free-to-paid conversion against real cohorts, and tune the funnel where the data disagrees with the plan.

Unit economics proven on live data

MONTH 7-12

Break even, then raise from strength

Reach roughly 350 paying merchants and cash-flow positive operations, ship the automations layer, and go into a Series A conversation with cohort data rather than a deck of projections.

Cash-flow positive · Series A ready

Built by someone who has **already done this by hand.**



Jake Ngatchu

Founder & CEO

Ex-bet365

Founder, Piranha Studios

Software engineer with a decade building commerce systems at scale, including at **bet365**, where the cost of a slow or broken transaction path is measured in seconds.

Founder of **Piranha Studios**, a development studio that builds composable commerce and custom digital infrastructure for SMEs and brands. StoreFactory came directly out of that work: the same six-week build, quoted over and over, to businesses that could rarely afford it.

That is the unusual part of this founder–market fit. The product automates a service he has **personally delivered by hand** — so the edge cases in provisioning, domains, payments and handover were known before a line of the platform was written.

Composable commerce

Scalable infrastructure

SaaS architecture

Full-stack engineering

SME delivery

FIRST TWO HIRES, FUNDED BY THIS ROUND

Growth marketer

MONTH 1–3

Owns content, Reddit and LinkedIn presence, SEO for booking and shop intent, and the community. The channel that has already produced 80+ signups at zero spend, run deliberately.

Customer success lead

MONTH 4–6

Onboards merchants, converts free accounts to paid, and turns support conversations into product signal. The single biggest lever on free-to-paid conversion.

Deliberately lean. Legal, finance and operations sit with external specialists, and Piranha Studios covers delivery capacity for done-for-you builds. The core team stays on product and growth, which is how a £150k round buys twelve months rather than five.



Every small business deserves the stack **only big ones can afford.**

We have made the six-week agency build into something a merchant can ask for in a sentence and keep changing forever — and we have done it at a price a barbershop can pay.

✓ **The product is done**

Live in open beta with real merchants trading, plans and billing switched on, and no build risk left to fund.

⚡ **The timing is now**

Agentic models, API-first commerce and cheap isolated compute all arrived at once. That window is open, and it is not wide.

||| **The ask is small**

£150k to reach roughly 350 paying merchants, break even inside twelve months, and raise the next round from data.

RAISING

£150,000 · Angel round

CONTACT

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TRY IT

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